

Lucian Gable

ACT I / Before the murder

Your history with Sterling

Sterling demanded a dangerous last-minute change to the centerpiece display and threatened to withhold your firm's final payment if you refused. He also planned to blame you publicly for any flaw in the opening-night presentation.

What you are hiding

You signed off on one temporary lighting rig that did not fully meet your own design standard because there was no time to rebuild it before the gala. Do not volunteer this immediately. In Act II, protect it unless interrogation forces your hand; in Act III, reveal it if you need to defend yourself.

Your objectives

- Keep Rafael from turning the temporary rig into a formal safety dispute.
- Find out what Riley changed after your final walkthrough.
- Make Malcolm admit the entrance sculpture blocks the intended sight line.

What you know about other guests

- Riley changed a lighting cue after your final walkthrough.
- Sterling threatened Malcolm's final payment over the entrance commission.

Notes / Who will you speak to first?

ACT II / After Sterling dies

Follow your assigned branch. Keep it private. If you are the murderer, the innocent branch is a cover story you may claim.

IF INNOCENT

Your brass screwdriver was found near the salon after circulating through installation work. During the poison window, the centerpiece lighting console records continuous manual adjustments under your designer code from the Grand Gallery. The console log clears your timing but exposes the unapproved temporary rig you signed off on.

IF MURDERER

At 6:45 you used a lighting check as cover to enter the salon. You poisoned Sterling's cordial and accidentally left your distinctive brass screwdriver near the service tray.

ACT III / Evidence update

Your sealed evidence pair contains Cards A and B. If you are INNOCENT, secretly submit Card B. If you are the MURDERER, secretly submit Card A. Put the unused card away.

FINAL STATEMENT / Read only if called

IF INNOCENT

I signed off on a temporary lighting rig I hated because Sterling would not delay the opening. That is the professional compromise I was hiding. The lighting console records my continuous manual adjustments throughout the poison window. The screwdriver looks bad; the console log is better.

IF MURDERER

Sterling wanted spectacle without consequence, speed without responsibility, and my signature beneath both. I went in under cover of a lighting check, poisoned the cordial, and left my screwdriver behind like an amateur. Apparently even perfect sight lines have blind spots.